

IO6 CARBON DISCLOSURE AND REDUCTION | O (MAX : 10 PT)

Intent : Reduce emissions from greenhouse gases to slow the global rise in temperature.

Summary : This WELL features requires organizations to assess and disclose their carbon emissions, set emission reduction targets, and progress toward carbon neutrality. Climate change as a result of human-caused changes to the environment represents the most existential threat to public health in the next half-century.¹ Without modifications to the world's energy and agricultural systems, the planet is on track to warm by 3 to 5 degrees by the end of the century.² This change will increase the frequency of extreme weather events, inundate coastal communities by rising sea levels, and create conditions more conducive to growth of destructive pest organisms, among other perils.¹ The 2015 Paris Agreement is a legally binding international treaty involving nearly 200 nations created in an attempt to keep the global rise in temperatures to less than 2 C above pre-industrial levels.³ Although some efforts to reduce emissions do come at higher initial cost than "business as usual", the benefits are far higher.⁴ In fact, the co-benefits alone of achieving the target (cleaner air as a result of a shift away from fossil fuel) substantially outweighs the cost of change.⁵ In addition to national goals, many organizations have made their own commitments to change. Many of these are modest,⁶ but others – such as those made in partnership with the Science Based Targets initiative (SBTi) – have been evaluated to align with the Paris Agreement goals.⁷ These goals are often categorized by their scope, where Scope 1 entails all emissions generated on-site, Scope 2 is all carbon emitted as a result of generating the energy used by the reporting entity,⁸ and Scope 3 includes all upstream emissions (from the supply chain), downstream emissions (from use of products), and other indirect emissions (e.g., employee commutes, business travel).⁹

PART 1 ASSESS CARBON EMISSIONS (MAX : 2 PT)

For All Spaces:

A carbon emissions assessment meets the following requirements:

- a. Is conducted for the entire organization associated with the property owner, builder, developer or management company.
- b. Is undertaken in accordance with one of the following:
 1. GHG Corporate Standard,
 2. ISO14064-1:2018, or
 3. Another program based on one of the above.
- c. Addresses scopes of emissions according to one of the tiers in the table below.

Scope	Points
All emissions in Scope 1 and Scope 2.	1
All of the above, plus all emissions from at least the top three categories of Scope 3 (include a justification for selecting these categories).	2

- d. Is reviewed and audited at least at the level of a Limited Assurance engagement (e.g., according to ISAE 3410 or AA1000AS).
- e. Is updated annually.
- f. Is prominently and publicly available (e.g., on company website, in annual report).

PART 2 SET CARBON REDUCTION GOALS (MAX : 3 PT)

Note :

To earn this part, projects must also achieve Part 1 at Tier 2.

For All Spaces:

The property owner, builder, developer or management organization meets the following requirements:

- a. Sets a carbon reduction goal that is prominently and publicly available (e.g., on company website, in annual report).
- b. Meets the requirements in one of the tiers in the table below:

Tier Carbon Reduction Goals	Point Value
Has submitted a commitment letter regarding their carbon reduction goal and is recognized as "Committed" by the Science Based Targets initiative.	1

- Selects a base year within the previous 5 years and the carbon reduction goals meet all of the following:
- Includes all emissions from Scopes 1 and 2, plus at least the top three categories of Scope 3.
 - Based on absolute emissions (i.e., not emissions intensity).
 - Includes targets of a year-over-year reduction of at least 3% for each of the next 10 years, or until carbon neutrality is reached.
- Has an approved science-based carbon reduction target and is recognized as "Targets Set" by the Science Based Targets initiative.

PART 3 MEET CARBON REDUCTION GOALS (MAX : 3 PT)

Note :

To earn this part, projects must also achieve Part 1 at Tier 2.

For All Spaces:

The property owner, builder, developer or management organization meets the following:

- a. Has set a carbon reduction goal at least one reporting year prior to pursuing this part. (This may have occurred prior to participating in WELL).
- b. Has met that carbon reduction goal, as calculated by one of the following:
 1. Emissions reduced between the most recent reporting year and the previous reporting year.
 2. Average emissions reduced year-over-year for multiple consecutive years (including an assessment undertaken not more than one year ago).

PART 4 ATTAIN CARBON NEUTRALITY (MAX : 2 PT)

Note :

To earn this part, projects must also achieve Part 3.

For All Spaces:

The property owner, builder, developer or management organization meets one of the following requirements in the current reporting year:

- a. Is certified as carbon neutral by a scheme that follows PAS 2060.
- b. Has purchased carbon credits and/or offsets from one of the following schemes to offset all emissions:
 1. Verra/VCS.
 2. Gold Standard.
 3. ACR.

REFERENCES

1. [https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanplh/article/PIIS2542-5196\(18\)30056-1/fulltext](https://www.thelancet.com/journals/lanplh/article/PIIS2542-5196(18)30056-1/fulltext)
2. <https://www.nature.com/articles/d41586-020-00177-3>
3. <https://unfccc.int/process-and-meetings/the-paris-agreement/the-paris-agreement>
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5. <https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/29615227/>
6. <https://www.bloomberg.com/graphics/2020-company-emissions-pledges/>

7. <https://sciencebasedtargets.org/how-it-works>
8. <https://www.epa.gov/climateleadership/scope-1-and-scope-2-inventory-guidance>
9. <https://www.epa.gov/climateleadership/scope-3-inventory-guidance>
10. <https://sciencebasedtargets.org/step-by-step-process>